

Bachelor's Thesis Proposal

A Taxonomy of Online Scams in Vietnam

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Co-assessor: To be decided

1 Motivation

Online fraud and scams are a growing problem in Vietnam. According to the research report from the Safer Internet Lab, in 2024, online fraud and scams resulted in substantial economic losses, approximately 18,900 billion VND [3].

Typical examples include impersonating banks, utility companies, or the police, as well as fake online jobs and investment schemes on social networks. Several tools have already been built that aid users. For example, the community project *ChongLuaDao* [2] allows users to check whether a given website is malicious. However, these tools target a specific scam and assume that the user already has a concrete *indicator*, such as a URL, a phone number, or a bank account.

Information about scam types exists mostly in the form of scattered news articles. There is no systematic classification of scams in Vietnam that people can consult to recognize the scam they are facing.

2 Objective

The objective of this thesis is to develop a *taxonomy* of online fraud and scams in Vietnam. Starting from real scam cases, the thesis will read and analyze them, categorize them, and organize the resulting categories into a hierarchy of scam concepts. Each concept should include at least a short description, examples of typical scripts, warning signs, and recommended actions.

The fraud and scams should be structurally classified, e.g., in the spirit of the ACM Computing Classification System [1].

The taxonomy should be stored in a typical management system and published as a simple web page so that people can browse the hierarchy to find the scam they are facing, and so that individual scam cases can be tagged with concepts from it.

3 Tasks

1. Review existing anti-scam tools and reports in Vietnam and their classification systems.
2. Create a collection of real scam cases from public sources, such as news articles and official warnings.
3. Read and categorize the cases, and organize the categories into a hierarchical taxonomy with a description for each concept.
4. Design a storage system to hold the classifications, descriptions, and recommendations of the categorized cases.
5. Create a simple web application to publish the taxonomy.
6. Document the methodology, the taxonomy, and its validation in the final report.

4 Deliverables

The following deliverables are due at the end of the project:

Final report Please have a look at the submission requirements in the following section. The final report should consist of an introduction, a (theoretical) background section, sections describing the work packages and their outcomes, and a conclusion. The report must be written in English.

Source code Complete, documented source code.

Presentation At the end of the thesis, a 20 minute presentation must be given in a thesis defense seminar. It should give an overview and discuss the most important highlights of the work.

References

- [1] Association for Computing Machinery. The 2012 ACM computing classification system, 2012. <https://dl.acm.org/ccs>.
- [2] ChongLuaDao. Chong lua dao. <https://chongluadao.vn>.
- [3] Nong Phuong Thao. Online fraud and scams in vietnam. Research report, Safer Internet Lab, 2025. https://saferinternetlab.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/06/Research-Report-A4_Fraud-Vietnam.pdf.

Thesis Submission Guidelines

Submission Requirements

- **Soft copy:** Submit via email to cse@vgu.edu.vn.
- **Hard copies:** Submit two (02) printed copies to the CSE Office (Room 511, Cluster 3).
- The Thesis cover requires at least 3 days to complete. Please make sure to prepare it at the photocopy shop as soon as possible.

Submission Timeline

- You may submit your Final Thesis Report (soft + hard) up to one week before the deadline.
- Early or late submissions will **NOT** be accepted.

Thesis Title Changes

- If you wish to change your Thesis title, please submit a "Request for Changing Thesis Title" by yourself.
- The request must be sent to us within the first four weeks of the preparation period.

Additional Resources

- Required forms and the Thesis template can be found at [Thesis Resources Link](#).
- Please read the Thesis Guidelines carefully.

Intellectual Property

Project: A Taxonomy of Online Scams in Vietnam

Assessor: _____

Student: _____

The student participates in this project at Vietnamese-German University (VGU) as a collaborator under the supervision of the assessor in the course of their studies towards the degree named above. The results produced during the collaboration, including the deliverables listed in Section 4, in particular the source code and the final report, constitute the "Research Results" and are governed by the following terms:

Confidentiality The student keeps the Research Results, together with any other information from the supervising research group at VGU that is declared confidential, confidential. This obligation persists until the student is informed that the intellectual property rights have been protected (e.g. through patent applications or other adequate measures) or that no protection is sought, and in no case for longer than twelve (12) months after completion of the collaboration.

Assignment of rights The student assigns to VGU their rights to the Research Results, including inventions and works protected by copyright. In particular, all rights to the commercial exploitation of the Research Results are ceded to VGU.

Patent cooperation If a patent application is filed for an invention based on the Research Results, the student provides all necessary signatures and remains available to support the application process, e.g. to respond to questions from patent examiners.

By signing below, the parties agree to the terms set out above.

Vietnamese-German University (VGU)

Place, Date

The assessor

The Student

Place, Date

The student